

Cellphones under review

The Federal Communications Commission wants to reopen an inquiry on harmful radiation from cellphones. <http://dgit.in/N9F2sM>



HTC One S is available online

The Android 4.0 ICS-based HTC One S is available on Indian online retailers' sites and available at ₹33,000. <http://dgit.in/LwGR0I>

been exhaustive studies in the US which have given a green signal to the use of Wii console in therapy.

For patients suffering from ailments, it is best to conduct Wii exercises under the guidance of a trained professional. "Individuals who choose to play the Wii at home may experience benefits similar to people who begin a walking program or start practicing Yoga. But for specific problems it is always best to seek a professional who can perform a comprehensive evaluation and teach the client the proper ways to utilize the specific activities to not only maximize benefit but also avoid injury," said Hinkel.

These Wii games are used across age groups. Exact figures are not available, but many therapists are making elderly patients use the Wii in therapy. We asked Dr. Hinkel how responsive such patients are to technology. "The older population in the US seems quick to embrace the Wii because they are familiar with computer games through their children and grandchildren." In fact we were told that a group of patients in one of her community care centres hold regular Wii bowling competitions.

With gaming comes the inherent motivation to get the highest score, sometimes causing one to spend hours playing a game. Now regular gaming where you are just stressing your thumbs and fingers is fine for long hours, but addiction and long hours playing a Wii game can lead to joint aches – which is disastrous for patients.

vision when starting activities geared at helping the issue," advised Dr. Herkel. *Quick read: <http://dgit.in/MX4IbR>*

India report

As we have seen above, using Wii for therapy is quite prevalent in the US. But the practice still hasn't gained popularity on Indian shores – maybe because we don't take gaming seriously? A quick search reveals fairly little data about the use of Wii for therapy. That's because there aren't any mainstream Indian hospitals incorporating Wiihab in their medical setup.

"Use of gaming as an adjunct to meet the therapeutic goals is unfortunately not practised in general at any rehabilitation centres or clinics for children or adults. While neuro-feedback and bio-feedback are topics covered in the curriculum of Occupational Therapy, use of Wii or PlayStation or Xbox is yet to gain popularity as a therapeutic activity for individuals having special needs," said Dr. Saif Bijliwala, Psychiatric Occupational Therapist and CEO of Jump Start Therapy Centre in Mumbai,

which is one of those rare places which actively pursues game therapy.

Jump Start Therapy centre started in 2008 and has been using game therapy since then. "Our clients are generally toddlers, children and adults who have

developmental handicapping conditions such as autism and related disorders, cerebral palsy, etc. Since one can develop many skills of clients, with these challenges, most parents who can afford



A child playing a game on EyeToy to improve reflexes and muscle strength at the Jumpstart Therapy Centre in Mumbai

Wii consoles generally buy it and use them at home," he said.

According to Dr. Bijliwala, one of the main reasons for Wiihab not picking up in India is the cost factor. "The cost of Wii is perceived as high. Adding WiiFit or dance mats is additional cost. Surprisingly clinics and even institutes for training professionals do not have gaming consoles," he said. Additionally, lack of awareness among the general public that a gaming device may help in recovery is a major deterrent.

Dr. Bijliwala also incorporates other gaming accessories such as the Eye Toy for PlayStation 2. The Eye Toy is basically a webcam-like device and captures the player on the TV and then the maps the players gestures within the game. According to him, most of the games that he uses with Eye Toy are regular games to be played on the touchscreen monitor, and were not designed specifically for therapy. There are, however, aspects of these games that stimulate specific areas of the brain. "Playing some of these games involves use of a lot of cognitive processes, which we can use to help our patients. Based on the condition of the patient we determine which games to use with them," he said. Hopefully we will see the Wiihab therapy adoption among Indian occupational therapists in the near future, as let's face it – who does not want to play a good game and get fit along the way – all within the comfort of your home. 



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- Dr. Saif Bijliwala

"Therapists are well aware of the possibility of overuse and are skilled at grading programs to help prevent such occurrences. If an individual has an orthopedic issue, it is best to seek professional super-